

NatWest Interview Experience

(Software Engineer Intern)

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About NatWest

NatWest Group is a major British financial institution formed in 1970 from the merger of National Provincial Bank and Westminster Bank. It is a leading bank in the UK offering a wide range of services to personal, business, and corporate customers through brands like RBS and Coutts. Headquartered in Edinburgh, Scotland, the company has grown through the merger of over 200 smaller banks. NatWest is committed to financial support, fostering innovation, and building sustainable value for its customers and shareholders.

Interview Rounds

The selection process for the **Software Engineer Intern** role consisted of two stages:

1. Online Assessment
2. Technical + HR Round

A total of **23 students** were shortlisted after the first stage for the final interview.

1. Online Assessment

The assessment comprised:

- **Coding Questions (2)**
 1. Sort the array of elements based on frequency.
 2. Group the odd numbers first and even numbers next in an array of integers.
(Both were relatively easy and straightforward to solve.)
- **Verbal Aptitude & General Aptitude**

- Topics: profit & loss, percentages, logical thinking, pattern finding.
- Difficulty: Moderate but time-consuming.
- **SQL MCQs**
 - Covered basic SQL concepts.
 - Manageable if you are confident with SQL fundamentals.

2. Technical + HR Round(30-40 min)

This was a combined technical and HR interview.

- **Introduction & Projects Discussion**
 - Began with a self-introduction.
 - Explained all three projects in detail; the interviewer appreciated the clarity and depth of explanation.
- **Technical Questions**
 - Why use **MongoDB over SQL**?
 - Write an SQL query involving **JOINS** based on my project's database schema.
- **HR Interaction**
 - Asked if I had any questions for them. I enquired about the interviewer's personal experience at NatWest.
 - Unlike my panel, some other interviewers also asked candidates DSA and behavioral questions.

At the end of the process, **9 students were selected** for the internship — I was fortunate to be one of them.

Key Takeaways

1. Practice **DSA problems daily** to stay sharp.
2. Have a **thorough understanding of your projects** — being able to explain them confidently makes a strong impression.

3. Communication is key: express your thoughts clearly and confidently.
4. Be genuinely curious to learn. Even if you don't know something, show eagerness to understand.
5. Start preparing early, and know your **resume inside out** — every point should be explainable.

Overall Experience

The NatWest interview process was a very positive and enriching experience. It tested my problem-solving ability, technical knowledge, and communication skills. More importantly, it highlighted the importance of being confident about your projects and fundamentals rather than just focusing on DSA. I thoroughly enjoyed the process and was delighted to secure the internship opportunity.

Contact

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If you have any doubts, feel free to reach out — happy to help!